Smart Budgeting and Financial Goal Management System

Project Charter & Scope Baseline

Official project name	Smart Budgeting and Financial Goal Management System
Prepared for	Team J
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Working draft. Confirm project-specific decisions with the team and supervisor before treating this document as approved.

1. Project overview

Smart Budgeting and Financial Goal Management System is a proposed personal finance web system intended to help users record income and expenses, plan budgets, track savings goals, understand spending patterns and receive explainable, data-based tips.

2. Business need

People can find it difficult to understand where money goes, control spending, save consistently and meet financial goals. A central personal-finance record and clear summaries can support better financial habits.

3. Project objectives

- Enable manual recording and maintenance of income and expenses.
- Support category-based budgets and spending comparisons.
- Allow users to define savings goals and record progress.
- Present dashboard summaries and date-filtered reports.
- Provide transparent rule-based insights from recorded information.
- Protect each user's personal financial records from access by other users.

4. Scope baseline

In scope for MVP	Out of scope unless formally approved
Registration/login; personal records; categories; budgets; savings goals/contributions; dashboard; reports/charts; rule-based insights; validation and ownership security.	Bank or mobile-money integration; automatic transaction imports; transfers/payments; lending/investment features; multi-user household accounts; AI dependency; multi-currency conversion.

5. Deliverables

- Approved SRS and use-case specification.
- ERD, data dictionary and architecture design.
- UI wireframes and API specification.
- Working MVP and database migrations.
- Test plan, test results and defect log.
- Deployment/setup guide and user guide.
- Final demonstration and project report/presentation as required by the course.

6. Constraints and assumptions

- The initial product is assumed to be a responsive web application.
- Users manually enter records; the system cannot independently verify whether figures are correct.
- Zambian Kwacha (ZMW) is proposed as the default currency; confirm with the supervisor/team.
- Rule-based insights are recommended for MVP; advanced AI is not required.

- Suggested stack is React + TypeScript, Django REST Framework and PostgreSQL; team approval is required.

7. Success criteria

- All agreed MVP user journeys work end to end.
- Calculations reconcile with independently calculated test examples.
- Cross-user access attempts are denied server-side.
- Core screens work on desktop and mobile widths.
- Team can install, run, test and demonstrate the system using documented steps.

8. Change control

Any feature added after scope approval should be recorded with its reason, impact on data model, time, testing and risks. The project coordinator and supervisor/team should agree before it becomes part of the baseline.